

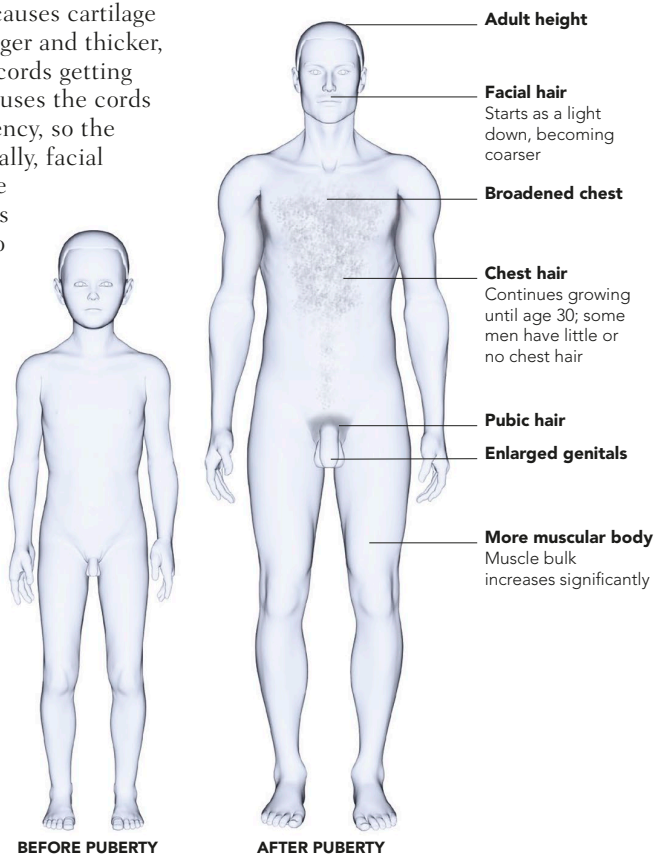
PUBERTY

AT PUBERTY, A NUMBER OF HORMONAL CHANGES STIMULATE PHYSICAL GROWTH AND THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE SEX ORGANS. IN BOTH SEXES, EMOTIONAL, BEHAVIOURAL, AND PSYCHOLOGICAL CHANGES ALSO OCCUR.

MALE PUBERTY

In boys, the physical changes of puberty start later than in girls, around age 12 or 13. Most show signs of development by age 14, and complete the changes of puberty by age 17 or 18. The testicles and penis get bigger first, then hair grows in the pubic area and armpits. Muscles increase in bulk, and some breast tissue might also develop. The hormone testosterone causes cartilage in the voice box to grow larger and thicker, which results in the vocal cords getting longer and thicker. This causes the cords to vibrate at a lower frequency, so the voice becomes deeper. Finally, facial hair appears, which may be accompanied by acne. Boys are more likely than girls to experience problems with perspiration and oily skin.

The sign of sexual maturation for boys is ejaculation. Although they are capable of having an erection from birth, boys only produce sperm when testosterone begins circulating in their bodies. It is then that they are able to ejaculate for the first time.



CHANGES IN THE BODY

Boys start growing later than girls. Once they begin growing, however, they grow faster and for a longer period, thus attaining a greater adult height. At age 14 or 15, the average boy is taller, heavier, and stronger than an average girl and is still growing.